



German women also played a big part in the triumph of Adolf Hitler as many German women supported Nazism, despite its similar doctrines to Italian fascism. The ideal German woman did not work, but instead built her life around “children, kitchen, and church”. In the federal elections of July 1932, 13.7 million Germans voted Nazi, and 6.5 million of those votes came from women.

25%
of the **British Union**
of Fascists in the
1930s were women

Resistance

On the other side, many women bravely opposed fascism. In Spain, fearless women, such as Dolores Ibárruri, General-Secretary of the Spanish Communist Party, called on the nation to defend democracy against fascism. General Francisco Franco, supported by Italy and Germany, led a rebellion and coup attempt against the Second Spanish Republic in 1936, and Ibárruri urged her fellow Spaniards to resist. Her country descended into a prolonged and vicious civil war, which eventually brought Franco to power in 1939. While Franco remained in power (until his death in 1975), Ibárruri, who had fled Spain, lived in exile in the USSR. She finally returned to her homeland as a national hero in 1977. Other women continued to fight while Franco was in charge: in 1939, the 13 Roses – a group of communist and socialist women between the ages of 18 and 29 – were executed by firing squad for working against the new fascist regime.